

Confidence Is Built, Not Bestowed

Confidence does not arrive before you act.

THE IDEA

Most therapists are waiting to feel confident before they act. But confidence is what you get *after* you act, not what gives you permission to. It builds from evidence: the accumulated experience of making a reasonable clinical decision, watching what happens, and surviving the result.

WHAT CONFIDENCE ACTUALLY IS

It is not certainty, and it is not calm. Confident clinicians still feel nervous and still get things wrong. What they have is a willingness to act on their best judgment, stay present with how it lands, and adjust, rather than waiting for a guarantee that no clinical situation can give them.

THE TRAP

If you only act when you feel sure, you never gather the evidence that would make you feel more capable. Avoiding the boundary, the direct observation, or the hard conversation keeps you comfortable in the moment and keeps your self-doubt exactly where it is.

TRY THIS

Pick one reasonable thing you've been postponing until you feel ready, and do it this week. Afterward, write down what actually happened, not what you feared would happen. That written record is the evidence your brain needs.

Confidence follows action. It does not come first.